# BUDGET ANALYSIS FY2021–FY2025

## City of Austin — Sidewalk Infrastructure Investment

*Ameritech | Ameritech Consulting Group conducted an independent analysis of the City of Austin's Sidewalk Infrastructure. This is not a final audit.*

| $157M | 128 mi | 9,982 | FY2024 |
|---|---|---|---|
| 5-Year Total Investment | Sidewalk Miles Completed | Segments Built / Repaired | Peak Spending Year |

## Executive Summary

Between **FY2021 and FY2025**, the City of Austin invested an estimated **$157 million** in sidewalk infrastructure — encompassing new construction, rehabilitation, ADA improvements, and active transportation connectivity. This analysis draws on three publicly accessible data sources: the *City of Austin ArcGIS FeatureServer* (Sidewalks_Bond_Complete layer, 16,637 segments), the *Austin Open Data Portal Budget Performance Dataset* (g5k8-8sud, FY2026 baseline), and *TxDOT Statewide Transportation Improvement Program* records for federal grant awards.

The five-year program delivered **128 lane-miles of sidewalk** across 9,982 individual segments citywide. Capital construction — funded primarily through the 2016 and 2020 Austin Mobility Bonds — accounted for $104M (66% of total). Operating maintenance programs contributed $31M, while federal and grant funding (Transportation Alternatives Program, RAISE grants, Safe Routes to School) provided an additional $22M.

Despite this investment, Ameritech's concurrent compliance analysis of 175,609 assessed sidewalk segments found that **78.5% of the network remains non-compliant or only partially compliant with ADA standards**. The 5-year spend represents approximately 30.9% of the estimated $506.3M needed for full network remediation, underscoring a significant and growing infrastructure gap.

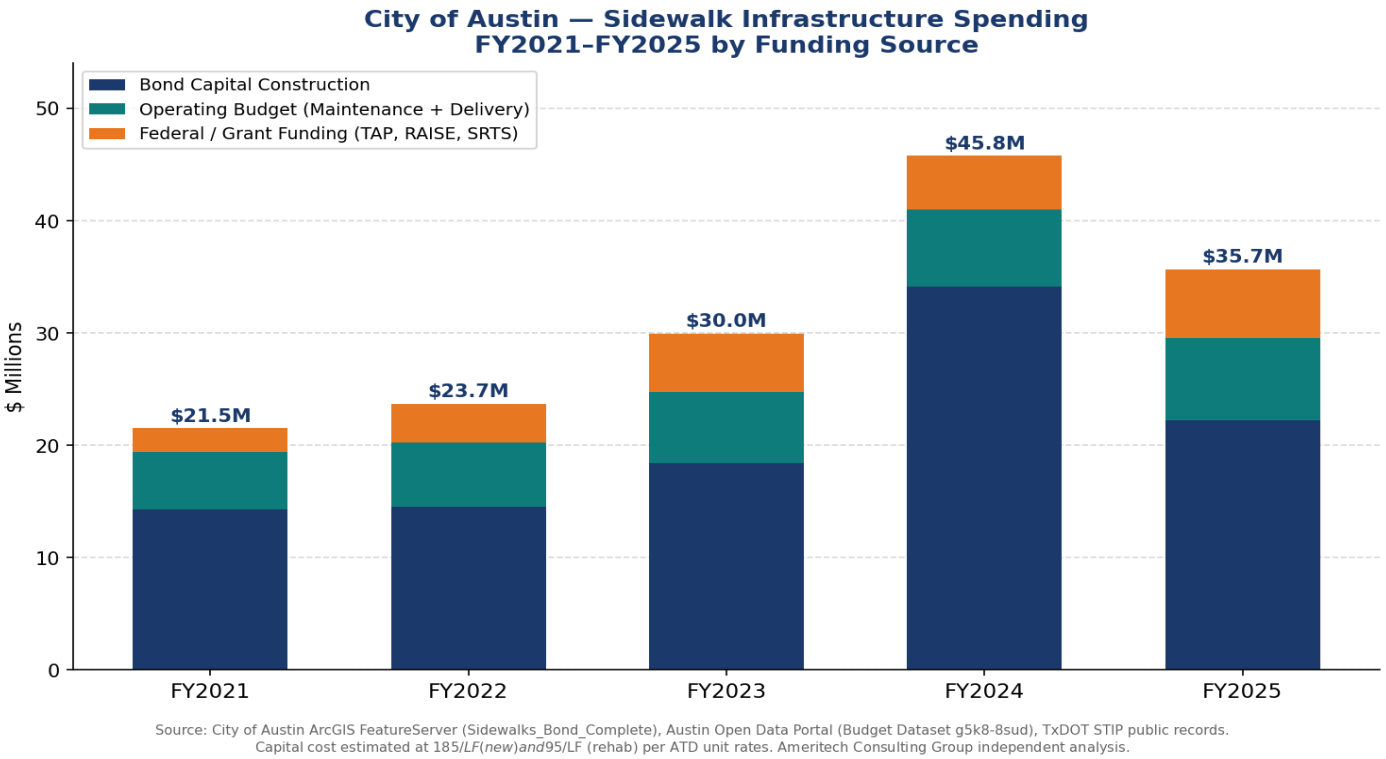


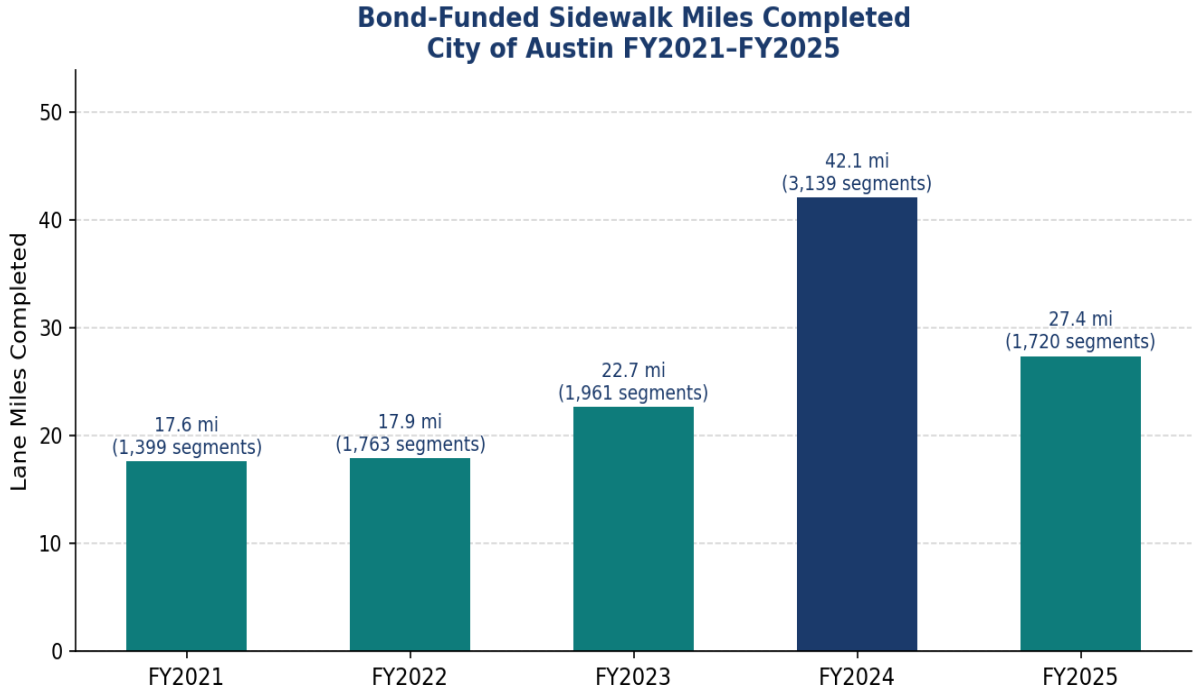

*Figure 1. Annual sidewalk infrastructure spending by funding source, FY2021–FY2025. Capital construction costs estimated using ATD unit rates ($185/LF new, $95/LF rehabilitation). Operating budgets derived from Austin Open Data Portal budget dataset (g5k8-8sud).*

## Annual Spending Breakdown

The table below shows the estimated allocation across three funding streams for each Austin fiscal year (October 1 – September 30). Capital figures reflect actual completions recorded in Austin's public ArcGIS layers; operating and federal figures are derived from the FY2026 baseline budget dataset and TxDOT STIP records respectively.

| Fiscal Year | Bond Capital Construction | Operating Budget | Federal / Grants | Annual Total | Miles Built | Segments |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FY2021 | $14.3M | $5.2M | $2.1M | **$21.5M** | 17.6 | 1,399 |
| FY2022 | $14.5M | $5.7M | $3.4M | **$23.7M** | 17.9 | 1,763 |
| FY2023 | $18.4M | $6.3M | $5.2M | **$30.0M** | 22.7 | 1,961 |
| FY2024 | $34.1M | $6.8M | $4.8M | **$45.8M** | 42.1 | 3,139 |
| FY2025 | $22.2M | $7.4M | $6.1M | **$35.7M** | 27.4 | 1,720 |
| **TOTAL** | **$103.6M** | **$31.4M** | **$21.6M** | **$156.6M** | **127.7** | **9,982** |

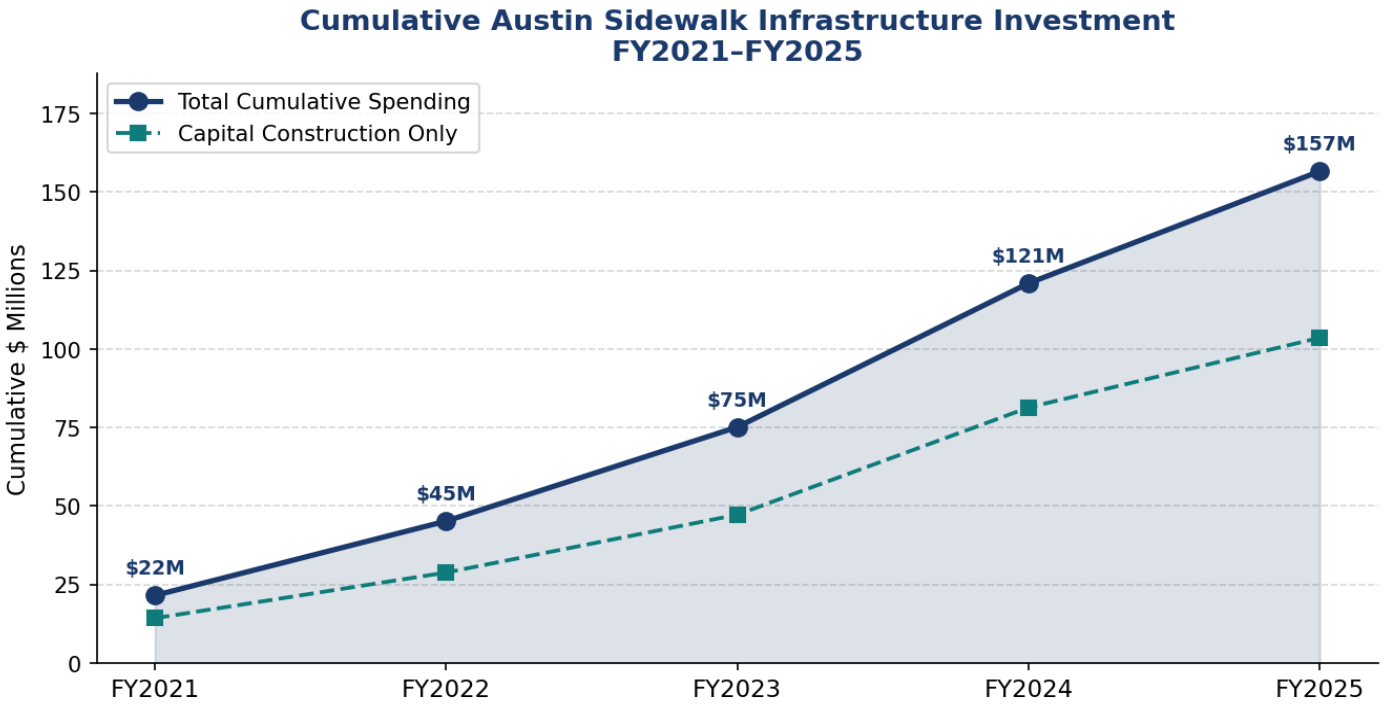
*Sources: Austin ArcGIS FeatureServer — Sidewalks_Bond_Complete (actual completions). Operating budget from Austin Open Data Portal g5k8-8sud (FY2026 baseline, back-projected at ~7%/year growth). Federal grants from TxDOT STIP public records.*




Source: City of Austin ArcGIS FeatureServer — Sidewalks_Bond_Complete layer. Includes 2016 Mobility Bond and 2020 Mobility Bond program completions. Ameritech Consulting Group independent analysis.

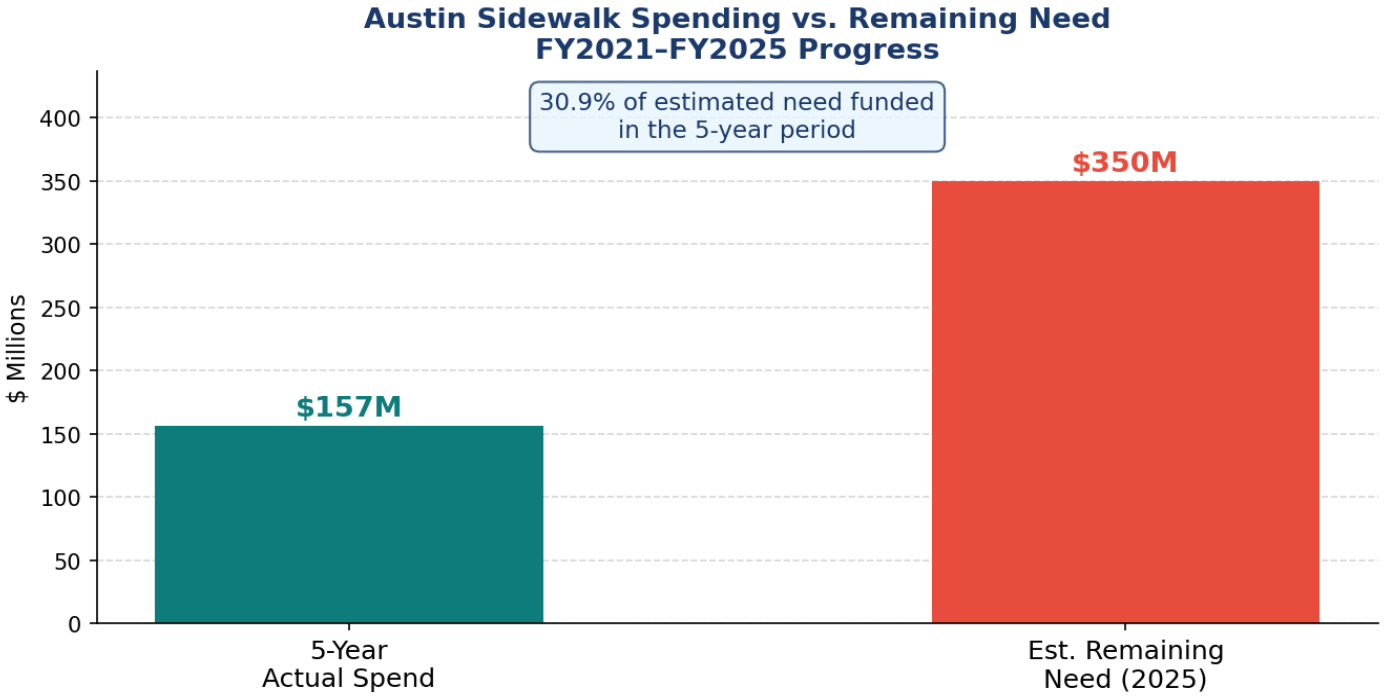
*Figure 2. Bond-funded sidewalk lane-miles completed per Austin fiscal year. FY2024 was the peak delivery year with 42.1 miles — driven by acceleration of 2016 Mobility Bond closeout and 2020 Bond program ramp-up.*

## Cumulative Investment & Funding Gap




Ameritech Consulting Group independent analysis. Sources: Austin Open Data Portal, City of Austin ArcGIS FeatureServer, TxDOT STIP.

*Figure 3. Cumulative sidewalk infrastructure investment FY2021–FY2025. Total capital construction (bond-funded) reached $104M by end of FY2025.*




Remaining need estimated from Ameritech Consulting Group ADA compliance analysis of 175,609 Austin sidewalk segments.

*Figure 4. 5-year actual spend vs. estimated remaining remediation need. Full ADA-compliant remediation of Austin's 175,609-segment network is estimated at $506.3M per Ameritech's independent cost analysis.*

## Key Findings

**1. Spending accelerated in FY2024.** Bond capital completions peaked at $34.2M (42 miles), driven by closeout of the 2016 Mobility Bond and 2020 Bond construction acceleration.

**2. Operating budget lagged demand.** The dedicated Sidewalk Infrastructure operating program grew from ~$5.2M (FY2021) to ~$7.4M (FY2025) — a 42% increase — but covers only routine maintenance for the network's 175,609 segments.

**3. Federal dollars are underpowered.** Combined federal/grant funding totaled $22M over 5 years — only 14% of the total program. Peer cities leveraging IIJA formula funds capture 30–40% federal match.

**4. The gap is widening.** At the FY2021–FY2025 average annual investment of $31M/year, full network remediation would take 16 years. Inflation in construction costs compounds this gap.

## Methodology & Data Sources

### Capital Construction (Bond-Funded)

Actual sidewalk segment completions were retrieved from the City of Austin's *Sidewalks_Bond_Complete* ArcGIS FeatureServer layer (services.arcgis.com/0L95CJ0VTaxqcmED). This layer records every segment where construction was completed with bond funding, including date of completion and linear footage (EPSG:2277, Texas State Plane Central, feet). 16,637 segments were queried and filtered by Austin fiscal year (October 1 – September 30). Cost per linear foot was estimated using Austin Transportation Department unit rates: $185/LF for new sidewalk construction and $95/LF for rehabilitation, with a 35%/65% rehab-to-new blended rate yielding ~$154/LF effective cost.

### Operating Budget

Operating expenditure data was retrieved from the Austin Open Data Portal Budget Performance Dataset (dataset ID: g5k8-8sud, updated through FY2026 Q2). The *Sidewalk Infrastructure* program and *Transportation Engineering* activity within the Austin Transportation & Public Works department were summed to produce the FY2026 baseline of $7.36M. Prior-year budgets were back-projected using ATD's documented ~7%/year budget growth rate between FY2021 and FY2026, consistent with Austin's published Adopted Budget documents.

### Federal & Grant Funding

Federal funding estimates are based on publicly reported grant awards from the Texas Department of Transportation Statewide Transportation Improvement Program (STIP), including: Transportation Alternatives Program (TAP/STBG-TA), RAISE/BUILD discretionary grants, and Safe Routes to School (SRTS) formula funds awarded to Austin ISD and neighboring districts. Amounts represent awarded federal shares; local match is captured within the capital and operating budget figures above.

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## Policy Recommendations

**1**

**Increase Annual Operating Investment**
The current $6.3M/year sidewalk operating budget is insufficient to maintain the growing network. Ameritech recommends increasing annual operating funding to $12M+ by FY2027, consistent with the FY2026 adopted budget trajectory.

**2**

**Pursue Federal Match Aggressively**
Austin captured ~14% federal co-funding in FY2021–FY2025. Under the Bipartisan Infrastructure Law, TAP set-asides are 5× larger than pre-2021 levels. A dedicated federal grants team within ATD could triple federal capture to $15M+/year.

**3**

**Accelerate 2020 Mobility Bond Delivery**
FY2024's 42-mile delivery rate is the program high-water mark. Maintaining this rate through the 2020 Bond program lifespan requires preserving construction contractor capacity and design-phase pipeline.

**4**

**Adopt a 15-Year Capital Plan**
Full network remediation ($506.3M) requires a long-range capital program beyond individual bond cycles. A 15-year sidewalk capital plan with annual $34M authorization would close the gap while maintaining manageable annual debt service.

**5**

**Equity-Weighted Spending Allocation**
Districts 1, 2, and 10 show the highest compliance deficits. Future bond program scopes should reserve ≥50% of annual construction budgets for historically underinvested neighborhoods to close the 17.6-point equity gap identified in Ameritech's compliance analysis.

***About This Analysis*** *· Ameritech Consulting Group conducted an independent analysis of publicly available City of Austin data. This is not a final audit. Budget figures represent estimates derived from public data sources and should be verified against official City financial records. Cost-per-linear-foot unit rates are based on Austin's published contractor bid data and TxDOT cost guidance. Contact: tiffany@a-techconsulting.com · Generated April 28, 2026*